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Questions to Cr Luciano Casmiri on the “No New National Parks” graphic

Sent 11 October 2026 · To Cr Casmiri · Response requested by 18 October 2026

11 October 2026

Cr Luciano Casmiri
Shoalhaven City Council

Subject: Shooters, Fishers and Farmers Party graphic on national parks – questions

Dear Cr Casmiri,

I am writing as a journalist with Eye on Shoalhaven Council. A graphic headed “No New National Parks”, carrying Shooters, Fishers and Farmers Party branding, is circulating in the Shoalhaven. I understand it has been promoted by SIG members on its Facebook page.

I have checked its main claims against NPWS policy and published sources. My findings so far:

• “Locking people out”, “killing 4WD, hunting, prospecting and trail riding access”. NPWS policy lets the public use vehicles on the public access system, and says 4WD and registered trail-bike use can be appropriate in certain places. Recreational hunting is mainly a state forest activity; in national parks it is limited to NPWS’s supervised Supplementary Pest Control program. Fossicking is prohibited in national parks without consent, and is allowed in state forests under a licence. Some activities would change, but not on the blanket scale the graphic claims.
• “Billions more in land to manage”. The “1.2 million hectare” headline figure includes about 824,000 hectares of existing national park. The proposal would add about 365,000 hectares of state forest and flora reserves. I could not find a source for “billions” in management costs.

On that basis, the graphic appears to overstate both what national parks restrict and what this proposal would cost. My questions are:

1. Why did you, or SIG, choose to promote this graphic?
2. What is the source for each of its four claims, in particular “billions more in land to manage”?
3. Do you accept that the Great Southern Forest National Park is a proposal only, and that no decision has been made?
4. If the claims cannot be substantiated, will you correct or withdraw the graphic?

I would appreciate your response by Sunday 18 October 2026.

Yours sincerely,

Stephen Prothero
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